

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 6

♦ A Q 8

♣ K Q J 7 5

♠ A 8 5 3

♥ Q 7 4

♦ 9 7 6 2

♣ 8 3



♠ J T 2

♥ 9 8 3

♦ J T 4

♣ 9 6 4 2

♠ K 6

♥ A K J T 5 2

♦ K 5 3

♣ A T

West

1 ♣

Pass

Pass

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

over-ruff. Otherwise you ruff with a small trump.

North

Pass

1 ♠

4 ♥

East

Pass

Pass

South

Dbl

3 ♥

North realizes that to make a takeout double, then jump in your own suit you must have a very good hand. So he bids the game. South plays 4 ♥. West leads the ♣K, which you take with the ♣A.

You have four losers. If you are thinking about leading toward your ♦K you are delusionary. West has the ♦A and you know it. Your best hope is to end-play West with the ♣T and force him to break the ♦s.

Play one round of trumps with the ♥A. You can't play any more because you will need an entry to dummy for the elimination.

Next play ♠K, ♠A and ruff a ♠ high.

Lead a ♥ to dummy's ♥Q. West shows out. Play dummy's last ♠. East is now void, so if he ruffs you

Now throw West in (you hope!) with the ♣T.

Fortunately West has to take the ♣T. Since he has nothing left but ♣s and ♦s he must lead one or the other. A ♦ lead will give you a trick with your ♦K and a ♣ lead will allow you to ruff in dummy (East still has a ♣) and discard a ♦ from your hand.

Some problems are tougher than others, this being a tough one.

It was not a complete elimination since East still had a trump when you threw West in. However, it worked because West was out of both ♠s and ♥s.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4
♥ K J 9 5
♦ Q J T 4
♣ Q T 9 2

♠ J T 9 7 5

♥ 7

♦ K 8 6 3

♣ K 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8

♥ Q T 8 4 2

♦ A 9 5 2

♣ A J 8

♠ A K Q 6 3 2

♥ A 6 3

♦ 7

♣ 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠

Pass 4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South
a winner. But it will still prove to be useful.

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ Q.

Unless West is real beginner East will hold the ♦ A so you should not try the ♦ K on this trick. And when West continues with the ♦ J you should again duck in dummy, ruffing with an honor in your hand.

The contract is in danger if East holds the ♣ A because you would have three ♣ losers to go with the ♦ already lost. One really good possibility is that East now has the lone ♦ A and you can set up dummy's ♦ K with a ruff.

So play a small ♠ to dummy's ♠ 9, (pulling the two outstanding trumps), and ruff another ♦ with an honor, hoping the ♦ A drops.

Too bad, the ♦ A did not fall so dummy's ♦ K is not

Play the ♥ A, then ruff a ♥ in dummy. Play a trump to your ♠ A and ruff your last ♥.

You are in dummy, just where you want to be. Play the ♦ K, and when East plays the ♦ A don't ruff but instead discard a ♣ from your hand. You knew all along that he held the ♦ A.

[showcards N:SJ,CK,C5,C3 S:S6,S3,C7,C6]

East is end-played, forced to either break the ♣ s and give you a ♣ trick, or give you a ruff-sluff.

This was the toughest hand so far and the end-play depended upon your correct reading that East must hold the ♦ A.

It also depended upon the defenders not switching to ♣ s at the second trick. If West had decided to switch to the ♣ Q you would have had no chance at all.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q T 8 5 2

♥ 6

♦ Q 9 7

♣ K Q 5 2

♠ 7 6

♥ K J 7 2

♦ A K 6 4

♣ T 8 3



♠ K 9 4 3

♥ 8 5

♦ T 8 5 3 2

♣ 7 6

♠ A J

♥ A Q T 9 4 3

♦ J

♣ A J 9 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

♥10 to dummy's ♥K, pulling the last trump as you enter dummy.

After hearing a limit raise, South's leap to 6♥ is, well, bold let's say. South plays 6♥. West leads the ♠5, East plays the ♠K.

Very bold in fact. The opening lead has exposed a ♠ loser in addition to your two ♣ losers. On the plus side dummy has an extra ♦ trick. You are going to have to try to throw West in with the ♣ suit, but you will have to be very careful with dummy's entries.

Win the ♠A, play the ♦J to dummy's ♦K and discard the ♠J on dummy's ♦A.

You are in dummy, so ruff the ♠7 with a high trump. Next play the ♥9 to dummy's ♥J. Both defenders follow, whew!

Back in dummy, ruff a ♦ with the ♥Q, then lead the

It would be great if you could ruff dummy's last ♦, then get back to dummy with a trump so you could lead a ♣ from dummy and finesse. But check your trumps. If you do that you will have no more trumps in your hand and West won't be endplayed because you have no ruff-sluff. The only thing you can do is to go ahead and play ♣s now, finessing into West and HOPING he has no more ♦s!

You were lucky, West had only three ♦s so your partial elimination worked.

But if it had turned out that West DID have another ♦, and led it, all would not be lost. You would ruff in your hand, play a trump to dummy, then take a second ♣ finesse. If it turned out the ♣K and ♣Q were in different hands you would make the slam.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J T 8 6 5 3

♥ T 5

♦ J T 8

♣ 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K Q J

♦ 7 5 2

♣ K J 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ -

♥ 8 7 4 3 2

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ T 9 8 7

♠ Q 9 4

♥ A 9 6

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q 5 4

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

6NT

2NT

All Pass

6NT by South follow.

[showcards N:SA,S7,S2 S:SQ,S9,S4]

Keeping your fingers crossed that West must win the next trick you play the ♠ 9. West puts on the ♠ T, you play low in dummy, and East (thankfully) discards a ♥.

[showcards N:SA,S7 S:SQ,S4]

West has been thrown in and he has nothing left but the ♠ K J. Whichever one he plays you will take the last two tricks.

West no doubt thought his 3 ♠ bid was a good idea.

In fact, it just kept you from making a losing play, (leading toward the ♠ Q), and allowed you to find the end-play to make the slam.

Some bidding, huh? Well, what would you have bid in the North seat? South plays 6NT. West leads the ♦ J.

Mirror distributions! So you can only make ten tricks in ♥s, ♦s and ♣s.

That means you will have to make two ♠ tricks. And since the odds are 5000 to 1 that West has the ♠ K, leading toward your ♠ Q is NOT your play.

Win the ♦ and play 4 rounds of ♣s. West follows to the first, then discards 3 ♠s.

Next play 3 ♥ winners. West follows twice, then discards a ♠.

Now play your 2 ♦ winners. East and West both

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
♥ 9 4 3
♦ J T 9 6
♣ Q T 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q J T 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K T 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♣	2♠	1NT
Pass	4♥		3♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South

started with 6 ♠s, his final 5 cards consist of 4 ♠s and one other. You play to the ♦A and East follows suit again.

[showcards N:S7,HQ,D5,D4 S:S8,HK,HT,D7]

Play dummy's ♠7. East will win, but he has nothing left but ♠s. When he plays another ♠ you discard your ♦ loser and ruff in dummy.

This is called a Partial Elimination because all of the ♦s were not eliminated.

However, the key is that you could tell they were eliminated from the East hand, and East was going to be the throw-in target because of his long ♠s.

In many hands an opponent who opens with a preemptive bid gives you the information you need to plan and execute the throw-in.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♠6, taken by East with the ♠A. East returns the ♠Q, you play the ♠K and West ruffs. West next leads the ♦J.

After that unfortunate start you seem to be in a bit of trouble. Two tricks are already in the defender's pockets and you still have a ♠ loser and a ♦ loser. So you win with your ♦K and play two rounds of trumps.

The good news is that West started with three trumps, and since he already used one it only takes two pulls to pick up the remaining trumps.

Eliminate ♣s by playing ♣A, ♣K, and ruffing a ♣. Both defenders follow to all three ♣s.

So far East has followed suit to every trick, meaning he has not discarded a single ♠. Since you know he plays to the ♦A and East follows suit again.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7
♥ K 9 7 3
♦ K 9 6 3
♣ K T 5 2

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 4
♥ J T 8
♦ J T 8 5 4
♣ A 9 3

♠ K Q T 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♥	Pass	1NT
Pass	4♠		2♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South

you will ruff in your hand and discard dummy's ♥ loser. So that defender is going to have to lead a ♥.

If it is West who won the ♦ K you are home free. His ♥ play will give you two ♥ tricks.

If it is East who won the ♦ K you still have a chance. He will lead a ♥ and you will finesse the ♥ Q.

In other words, played this way you make the contract whenever West holds the ♦ K **OR** East holds the ♥ K.

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With the cards as shown the elimination play works.

But if the ♦ K is with East and the ♥ K with West it wouldn't.

Of course it is POSSIBLE that if you played a low ♦ from dummy some Easts would duck and let you win a trick with your ♦ Q.

This trickery would fail if West held the ♦ K, or if East held it and went up right away.

North first transfers you to ♠s, then closes the auction with 4♠.

South is to play 4♠. West leads the ♣2. East takes the ♣A and returns the ♣9 to West's ♣K. West plays another ♣ to your ♣Q.

With two tricks lost already you have a sure ♦ loser (unless the defenders goof) and a ♥ loser that might be taken care of if East holds the ♥K. But what if West holds the ♥K? Maybe an elimination play.

First pull trumps - they split 2-1.

Next eliminate ♦s by playing ♦A then another ♦. This does the elimination and throw-in at the same time.

If the defender who won the ♦K plays a ♦ or a ♣